

International Falls Land Port of Entry Improvements Study Environmental Impact Statement

Background

The existing International Falls, Minnesota, Land Point of Entry (LPOE) facility was deficient in size, layout, and functionality. The deficiencies prevented the U.S. Customs and Borders Protection and other federal agencies, assigned to the LPOE, to adequately fulfill their respective missions. The U.S. General Services Administration (GSA), Region 5, proposed to replace its existing LPOE with a new, \$50 million facility that would improve the operational efficiency, safety, and security for both federal agency personnel and cross-border travelers.

Scope

Gannett Fleming prepared an environmental impact statement (EIS), documenting the planning and potential environmental impact of replacing GSA's international LPOE.

Our firm developed and considered no-build and five build alternatives for the replacement of the existing LPOE. The selected alternative consists of demolishing the existing facilities and constructing a new state-of-the-art LPOE on a 15-acre site, southeast of the existing site.

Primary environmental issues and concerns assessed within the study, include potential impacts to the Rainy River water quality; effects to historic resources that are potentially eligible for the National Register of Historic Places; and, due to potential changes to traffic patterns, the interruption or loss of revenue to the merchants in the International Falls central business district.

Accomplishments

Our firm provided environmental planning and documentation services in accordance with the National Environmental Policy Act (NEPA) and GSA's policies and procedures for implementing NEPA.

Our firm also provided cost estimates in support of conceptual engineering services provided by others.



The 24-hour LPOE serves as a crossing for vehicles, trains, buses, and pedestrians.

Client

U.S. General Services Administration,
Region 5

Location

International Falls, Koochiching County,
Minnesota

Fee

\$168,135

The EIS was prepared in a readable and understandable format, with color graphics and illustrations. The attractive, concise, and reader-friendly format of the EIS facilitated a timely and smooth public review process.

Key Services

- Environmental planning and analyses
- EIS preparation and distribution
- Public involvement and agency coordination
- Conceptual design and cost estimates prepared for relocation portion of the railroad